

THE BIRTHING PROCESS -- COSMIC PULSE

My dearly beloved friends, so much love and so much blessings go forth to all of you. Your human struggle to grow out of the mazes, your growth and expansion is a golden light that illuminates all of the universe. It is a powerful force that you may not feel at this moment because there is still so much disconnectedness. But gradually the connections are being made until at one time all flows together, and there is no more puzzlement, no more fear, no more pain -- only peace and joy. On a deep level of your being that exists already now, there is a hidden part in you in which you know. To make this knowledge available is the great task you are all involved with.

There are isolated moments in which you experience the hand of God in your life, the breath of God, as it were. Such a moment may occur at any time, triggered off by certain experiences either within or outside of you. It is then when the inside and outside fuse, and it all becomes one reality. It is then that you know God's reality. There simply is no longer any doubt about it. The peace and joy you then experience cannot be put into words. You know that all the isolated goals you pray for become only this one central point: experiencing the reality of God. When this is the case, you are already pure, at least in that moment in time, for the purity of your unclustered, unobstructed spirit is freed through all the shells and layers. So you do not have to pray for purification.

In such a moment, you know all you need to know -- in that instant in time. So you do not have to pray for insight and enlightenment and understanding. You understand, you know, you are enlightened. In such a moment, love flows through every vein of your body and soul. So you do not have to pray for love. In that moment, you activate the greatest healing power there is. So you do not have to pray for healing. In such a moment, you have strength, imagination, resourcefulness, and creativity. So you do not have to pray for success. In such a moment, you also have measure, so that you know what is right and possible for your earthly existence at this juncture of your evolution.

So all the various prayers flow into this one central point. When these rare moments occur, you are bathed in the grace of God. With such an experience you come to understand that all you really need to pray for is to experience God's presence, God's hand in all of life, God's breath in your own existence. But until such time, it may often be necessary to fragmentize your prayers for your own focus and deeper understanding of what is necessary at any given time in your life. You need to impress yourself with certain aspects that need to be concentrated on. So I want you to understand that these words do not mean that you should cease praying for specific aspects that fill out the total picture. The time will come, however, when you will simply pray that you can contact the power and presence of God without these special occasions that come only rarely at first and that seem to depend on circumstances outside yourself. Eventually you will be so uncluttered, so freed, that the Light will become more frequently available. At first it will always be an indirect,

apparently involuntary occurrence, an occurrence that happens without anything that you have caused. But it is a direct result of efforts, positive intentionalities, and commitment to God's will. But cause and effect are removed from one another on the level of appearance, through time. As you have often experienced in other aspects, as you grow as a whole, cause and effect move closer together until a direct link can be seen. When this occurs in regard to experiencing the power and presence of the Creator, you have attained self-realization. You have purified and unified yourself. Then you can be one with Him at will, with the outer will, which is totally compatible with the will of the Highest.

This gradual process depends on your willingness to open your heart. It seems to require a special kind of courage to open your heart. You must be willing to risk the imaginary dangers to feel with your heart -- to feel yourself, your lovingness, your vulnerability, the beauty of creation, the endearment of others who struggle in their attempt to find the light. When you are willing, truly willing, the Christ spirit will take over and perform the "operation" to remove the tight lock from your heart that has existed for millennia. The more your heart is open, the more God can enter with His magnificent reality. You will be touched by His breath more frequently, you will sense His hand in all things.

In this lecture I would like to discuss particularly a law of timing that applies to the development of every entity. You surely must have sensed this law and even vaguely know about it. But it is important that you thoroughly understand it. This law means that there exists a certain necessary time sequence in the process of an individual's path. This time sequence is entirely different for every entity. What, for one person, needs to be taken at the very beginning -- constituting a fundamental key without which nothing further can be genuinely accomplished -- may follow only much later for another. You know that you are working with different levels and layers. You know about the spiral movement that seems to bring the same sequence up again and again. But then there comes a point when a particular spiral has truly resolved itself. An entirely "new" aspect is coming to the fore, an aspect so strange and unfamiliar that it seems at first somewhat frightening: "Is that really me?" It is here not merely a question of going to a deeper level of the same. The deeper level brings new material to the fore that could not have been handled before. This phenomenon sometimes causes a feeling of hopelessness about self-purification: "Will it never end?" But I want to warn you about this and tell you it is a good sign of deep progress.

In the lives of the average human being who is far from pursuing any path of self-confrontation, who ignores even the possibility of inner growth and development, these previously concealed aspects are taken on as new tasks in a new incarnation. Specific circumstances and surroundings are geared to bring out these aspects that could not be brought to the fore in the previous incarnations, in which circumstances and surroundings had to activate other material. With people who follow an intense path, such as you do, it might happen that what would have waited for a future incarnation under "normal" circumstances, is released now. The inner timetable has readied the soul for it now, since all the intended work has been completed before physical life is terminated.

While you go through these additional tasks -- which were not certain that you might be able to master before your incarnation -- this may seem too much. It may appear to you to better leave it for a later time when you have gathered new strength in your spiritual home. And often this is true and not even attempted. But when it is attempted, the benefit is immense. It is an immeasurable amount of "saving" for you, saving much energy and expenditure, time and creativity, that would

otherwise have to be distributed over new incarnations particularly destined for fulfilling these tasks. Also, do not forget that when such additional new material comes to the fore to be taken on by you, it is never without your utter consent. Often you wish it, and your spiritual advisors do not agree. Often they do agree and warn you, but you understand in a state of greater consciousness and vision that it is truly worth it to undertake this extra task in the same incarnation.

A long time ago I discussed some aspects about the processes of reincarnation. You may remember that I said then that in the preparation before incarnation the life plan is exactly prepared and etched into the soul substance. I say to you now that the soul substance contains much more than merely the life plan of the current incarnation. There is an overall plan that shows what has been accomplished in the past and shows that there are the future tasks necessary to fulfill, stacked as layers, as it were. It is difficult to convey these facts in human terms. It may sound oversimplified and therefore misleading. Of course in our reality there is no such thing as up or down, below or above, or, for that matter, time itself. So we cannot speak of past and future. Yet there is a sequel, a rhythm that takes its natural course. One step must logically follow the previous one. Each step or phase has a meaning and cannot possibly be undertaken at the wrong juncture of the sequel. So only in that sense is there past or future, layers above and layers below.

I often mentioned that some human beings occasionally experience a rebirth within this incarnation. When Jesus spoke about the necessity to be born again, he not only referred to the reality of reincarnation. He also meant that in order to experience the truth of the living God within, a rebirth must take place. This is made possible by fully following the life plan for this incarnation and then freeing those plans that might have waited for a subsequent embodiment.

The process of birth is never, under any circumstances, a one-time phenomenon. It is always gradual. Even on the purely physical plane, a human being is not born complete. The baby leaves the womb of the mother and first becomes merely a physically separate entity. Even this physical separation is still not complete right away. It takes a while until mother and child are truly separate entities. And I do not mean this in terms of independence and self-sufficiency, for obviously the child is not able to fend for himself for a long time.

If you think carefully, you will note that all the childhood years are part of the birth process. Gradually the mind is being freed, released, being born into the physical reality, as it were. More gradually the person's spiritual nature and higher values are being born, though not always. They often remain unborn, waiting for a future existence to be released. Talents often take time to be born, in most instances considerable time. Accomplishments which the soul has acquired in previous lives need to be nurtured, the technicalities learned for this body, so that the inner knowledge has an adequate instrument to express itself.

The time has come for you, my friends, to become more aware of these possibilities -- of incarnatory processes reaching the surface only now, or at a later period, when sufficient groundwork has been done, when your current life plan has been fulfilled. You need to listen sensitively into your entire path process and occasionally gain sufficient distance from yourself to have an overview. You will then sense when a rebirthing process has begun. With some this may never be, not necessarily because they do not work as dedicatedly as others on their own purification but perhaps because the present task is so vast and all encompassing that it suffices for this embodiment. So do not expect this to happen in all instances.

Also you need to be aware of too simple and quick assumptions in this respect. Oftentimes a new phase on your path merely indicates another facet of the present life plan and not one that has been left conditionally as a possibility now or perhaps in a later incarnation. I would not like to see this community rushing en masse into this explanation every time you enter another facet of your inner development. A finely attuned sensitivity will give you a deeper understanding about these processes. It will also make you realize that divine birth is never a one-time event. It is always an extended birthing process.

You keenly participate in your own birthing process by the work you are doing on this path. Consider the entire purification work as a birthing process. For you truly give birth to your unobstructed, unencumbered spirit in its full glory. You eliminate, step by step, the enfolding layers. When your spirit is being born, it always happens in gradual parts. One aspect was already born when you came into this plane. Other parts shed the covers later, one by one. Finally, at one point in time, your spirit will stand free and unencumbered without any covers, any obstructions, any layers that need to be removed.

I cannot stress emphatically enough that you not take this lightly. This concept should not be bandied about in a facile spirit. Not every insight revealing a hitherto unfamiliar pattern, not every new phase, indicates the process of uncovering material that may have ordinarily waited for a future incarnation.

The information I give you here is not to be confused with the practice of many psychics who tell a person where, when, and as what he or she has lived in previous periods of history. Such information is usually, with few exceptions, pointless and only serves sensationalism. Only when traits and attitudes are under discussion is this of any value. And even then in most instances, the realization, if necessary, should come from yourself through your own intuitive sensing. Then such insight will complete a picture that has bearing on your present struggle, on your current task.

The process of birth, as I started saying, is always an ongoing phenomenon. Perhaps it will help you to visualize the universe as a breathing entity. Each breath is a pulsation that penetrates onward, that bleeds through previously inert mass -- the mass of the void. Once the pulsation reaches this mass sufficiently strongly and often, the mass begins to soften. The breath of life enters, and consciousness is being born where there was previously no life, no consciousness, no being. Each breath consists of expansion, contraction, and the static moment between. Each of these movements is designed to expand life, to spread it. The pulse of life surges on. Each pulsation is another thrust of the life force, penetrating matter and gradually infusing it with life.

Each incarnation on the earth plane represents a pulse beat, an outbreathing. Each time life seems to die, it represents an inbreathing. The strength of the pulse beat is determined by the will to live on earth in the body, by the fulfillment of the task the entity has come for. If the task is negated because the inner life and truth are denied, the will to live is usually weak, although the reverse is not necessarily true. It is possible that the will to live is strong, and yet the path is negated. In such instances, the spirit has justified hope that at least part of the task may still be accepted, may be allowed into surface consciousness.

Old age is a slow withdrawal of the personality that lives forever. When you humans speak about dying, it seems absurd to us from our vantage point. There can never be death, there can only be a withdrawal of life from the outer encrustations, leaving them inanimate again. When the entity builds a body, this body consists of material that is as yet lifeless but that will be enlivened once the spirit or the soul or the person with all his traits and all the special combinations of attitudes that form his/her unique personality, as it exists at this point of evolution, takes possession of this shell.

Each further incarnation represents a further thrust into the inanimate. Very gradually the pulse beat of life, in this particular regard, will have become so strong that matter is no longer matter, is no longer inanimate ever. It remains forever imbued with spirit. It has become so refined, its vibratory frequency so high, that it can no longer decay. It has been wholly made into spirit. It has been so absorbed by spirit, by life, by consciousness, that it has become spirit, life, consciousness.

These are not idle speculations. You can observe this truth on your earth plane by a very simple fact. The extension of life, of the average age of the human being, is a direct result. Not too long ago in your history, the average age was thirty years. Now it is seventy. In the not too distant future, even in your terms of time, the average age will be one hundred years and over. The inner meaning of this fact is that matter is more strongly imbued with life. Life can therefore have a greater staying power. The forward thrust of the pulse beat can penetrate deeper.

Everything that exists in creation exists in the macrocosm and the microcosm. It is repeated over and over in different proportions, to different degrees, in different ways. So the breath of life, cycles of life, principles of life -- they all exist in smallest and in largest measure based on the same creative conditions and laws. It will be helpful for you to visualize life as an ongoing breathing phenomenon -- each incarnation representing a pulse beat, each withdrawal from matter, not as a dying of life, but as a withdrawal from matter, an inbreathing. In this vision you will strengthen yourself and open up new doors of understanding.

Now it is of the greatest of importance for you to fully understand what constitutes the strength of the pulse, the breath of life that is a human life. What determines the vigor of the pulse beat -- that single cosmic beat that is a human incarnation? But before discussing this, I should like to add here that not only human life fulfills this function. The earth plane is an arena designed to particularly serve the purpose of "breathing into the inanimate," or the void, if you will. Every plant, every animal, every life form existing on this plane, breathes into matter and enlivens it. First only temporarily, for after a while this life withdraws again only to reappear at certain intervals. But the time will come when life can no longer withdraw, even in plant, mineral, and animal life. Vibrations of matter will have so refined that matter will become spirit. Then the breath of life exists in a way that life no longer pulls back. The thrust will have become so strong, that all is life, all is spirit.

The human state of development is constituted differently from other life forms on earth. There, consciousness plays a major role. After a certain degree of evolvment has been attained, consciousness can determine the strength, vigor, length of the thrust of the pulse beat. This happens through several factors.

In the first place, the understanding of these cosmic processes is necessary. This is why I give you this lecture. If you can think and visualize life in these terms, you will sense the truth on an

inner level. Only in the rarest of instances is such a vision attained without outer help and stimulation, by discussing these factors. Now mankind has reached a point in its overall development when this help needs to be given so as to accelerate the process. When you perceive life and death as a pulsating breath, when you experience the spirit as the constant that pushes into matter, your entire world picture is going to change. If you permit this new consciousness to grow in you, to take hold of your being, you must experience life, death, and all happenings in a very different way -- a way that is liberating and a way that will eliminate the existential anger, rage, and fear about life and death we discussed in another recent lecture. But to hear this and file it away as another spiritual "information" is not enough. You need to stretch your own imagination, your inner senses, your deeper vision so as to make this knowledge gradually your own experience.

Another determining factor is, of course, your attitude. When difficulties come, it is human to be discouraged. When you are puzzled or in pain, when you are disappointed or unhappy about something, it is most normal to lose courage. You cannot help it. But with this inner consciousness growing in you, you will perhaps gradually learn that it is most essential to keep the vigor toward life intact, to not allow negative experiences to weaken your inner pulse. Your inner will directly effects the pulse beat of your life force. Your choice to want to master the situation, make the best of it, learn from it, live it to the fullest, directly affects the vigor of the cosmic pulse beat that enlivens your personal existence.

This requires, in addition to the understanding I mentioned, good will, courage, and faith, which come to the degree you truly want to fulfill your part in creation. Every created being plays such a part, without exception. For every being is a direct expression of the Creator. In every being, a part of the Creator lives. The entire plan of salvation is a conjoint effort to penetrate all with life, with consciousness, with the divine joy that is so exquisite that it cannot be conveyed in words.

I mentioned before that everything exists in microcosm and macrocosm, in many repetitions, for the principles of creation are perfect and can be adjusted to many different situations and conditions. Let us now think of the phenomenon of the pulse beat. In the human body there is the pulse that indicates the vital signs, the functioning of blood, heart, arteries. Now, on a larger scale, each human life, each life manifestation, is a cosmic pulse beat. This one pulse beat that constitutes an entire incarnation consists of many "smaller" pulse beats, for lack of a better word. What I want to say is that the pulse beat is repeated many times during a life time in order to pump the spiritual blood into hardened, inanimate matter. So you have these many beats taking place during the course of a lifetime. These beats vary. At times the beat is vigorous, other times the beat weakens. And then there is the overall pulse beat that is the entire incarnation.

You can see here how the same creative principle repeats itself and manifests in different ways. As I mentioned before, there are isolated occasions when a person will live his or her next incarnation, or at least part of it, in the same incarnation if the same has already been totally fulfilled. Instead of the life withdrawing, a new pulse beat sets in, heralding another set of conditions, another task -- often within the framework of the same overall task and outer life circumstances that need not necessarily change at all. Sometimes, though, they change drastically. It all depends.

The new pulse beat is often weak at first. A break has occurred, even though the break is not as crass as the body dying and later being reborn under entirely new conditions. But the break nevertheless exists. It is often experienced as intense, sometimes prolonged crisis. Since crisis is

painful, it weakens the pulse beat. Only as the new life is fully understood and embraced, can a new continuity begin to evolve, and the new cosmic pulse beat in the entity resumes with renewed vigor.

When you hear these words, you may fear such an occurrence. You may think it preferable to do it in slower stages. I say to you that quite apart from the tremendous value for your personal evolvment and for the overall task of the great plan, it is erroneous to think that the transition into a new incarnation within the same body is more traumatic than the greater break of dying and being reborn. In many human beings fear of death makes dying traumatic. The threat of extinction prevents the entity from experiencing the sweetness of the transition. In many instances this can be experienced only much later, after the real has been severed from the temporary.

And birth is always traumatic and painful. I spoke about this before in another context. The personality needs to squeeze into a very tight stricture that is experienced as painful. When you see the baby's struggle and resistance, it is not difficult to perceive this. It is also traumatic for the entity, before the birthing process into matter begins, to temporarily abdicate full consciousness and to await that it slowly reawakens by stages. This seems often risky. Will all that you know as unencumbered spirit reach the brain through matter and through the dimmed experiences of earth life? Is it not much more preferable to stay in the continuity you have gained through your growth and development? The break in consciousness can be avoided in that way. This is not always possible, but there are instances when development proceeds very fast and very well when this opportunity arises. However, as I said before, do not assume anything too quickly and too glibly. Let it rather be a question within, that may or may not find the answer. If it is necessary and important for you to know, if you are open without any preconceived ideas one way or another, you will know. Most certainly you should not ask me whether or not this is so.

There is a general acceleration in the process of evolution. This manifests in various ways. For one, never before has knowledge of the inner realities been accessible to the general public. This is unprecedented in your history. In former times, there were only an elect few who could join a secret esoteric society, or what might be called a mystery school, in which knowledge about inner truths, real values, purification processes were disseminated. Nowadays it is open and available to all. The fact that many do not make use of this possibility is due either to the lack of development of some souls reaching the earth plane and so making them unable to understand or to the fact that many, many would have the capacity but do not move out of their resistance and apathy. They do not fulfill their potential. Another manifestation of the acceleration in development is exactly what I explained in this lecture: the possibility to uncover layers of the soul that would ordinarily await a future embodiment.

In this ever increasing acceleration of the movement of divine life, the penetration of life into the void becomes ever deeper and stronger with each embodiment, even by those who do not fulfill all their potential or those who are still on a much lower scale of consciousness. Even trees, plants, birds, or what have you -- their life span is not longer in your terms, but the general movement causes their real, eternal being to penetrate deeper into matter so that this matter is altered after their life is withdrawn. The entire process is heightening and quickening.

This fact brings about a particular phenomenon that, seen from the outside and out of context, may seem to contradict what I say. It is the fact that in your era there is a new balance between developed and undeveloped souls. As there are highly developed spirits coming into this

plane in ever greater numbers, so are there also an increasing number of undeveloped souls reaching this plane. In former times these differences were much less. There was a greater leveling. Less highly developed souls made the existing primitive incarnations less outstanding. Now the differences are striking.

For you who work on this path, it is important to be aware of these general cosmic processes and incorporate them into your understanding about the world and yourself. At certain stages, such knowledge would not help you at all and not be relevant to what you are called upon to deal with. But the time comes when this is important, not just for some of you individually but for the entity path as a whole. For what occurs to you individually, repeats itself on a larger scale -- always. So your individuality is a cell of the entity pathwork. The entity pathwork is a cell of the entity earth plane. The healthier each cell becomes, the better the total organism can function. And health includes knowledge and understanding.

Your entity pathwork has been reborn several times already. It will continue to do so if you give your best to your own truth and development and to the task of which you are a blessed part. I say this to you now because at this very period you, as a community, go through such a process. By understanding this fact, it will be much easier for you to grope and search, to struggle and stretch to find new modalities, to make changes that in the end, if you allow divine inspiration to reach you, can only become a blessing for every individual joining this venture, on all levels. Be fearless in your trust and faith that you are involved in something infinitely bigger than your personal little concerns, that sometimes take on a disproportionate importance, when viewed from an angle of larger truth.

The Christ spirit is with you, all of you, at all times, in all things. God's blessings ennoble your most mundane undertakings, for they are put into the service of the divine cause. Let your inner joy reach your consciousness, for there is only cause for rejoicing!

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